भारतीय मानक ब्यूरो IS / ISO XXXXX
मानकः पथप्रदर्शकः
BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS

भारतीय मानक ब्यूरो IS/ISO 14001
मानकः पथप्रदर्शकः
BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS EMS

भारतीय मानक ब्यूरो IS 18001
मानकः पथप्रदर्शकः
BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS OHSMS

भारतीय मानक ब्यूरो IS/ISO 50001
मानकः पथप्रदर्शकः
BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS EnMS

मानकः पथप्रदर्शकः

BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS

Manak Bhavan, 9, Bahadurshah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002

Website : www.bis.gov.in; Email : mscd@bis.gov.in

Design & Printed at Viba Press Pvt. Ltd., 9810049515

मानकः पथप्रदर्शकः

BUREAU OF INDIAN STANDARDS

Auditor Book

Chapter 21: Reporting on Non-Conformities (NCs) for Improvement

1.0. After Conclusion of Management Systems Certification (MSC) audit, findings are reported through following:

A. Non-Conformities (NCs);

B. Opportunity For Improvements (OFIs); and

C. Observations (Please refer to Chapter 9)

2.0. Non-Conformities (NCs):

Absence of, or failure to implement and maintain, one or more management system requirements on a situation which would, on the basis of available objective evidence, raise significant doubt about its ability to meet conformance to the requirements.

To be more precise on NCs, different Certification Bodies (CBs) further grade them into Major NCs and Minor NCs for facilitation of corrective actions to be taken in a time bound manner.

3.0. Classification of NCs:

(a) <u>Major NCs</u>: Non-existence of, or failure of one or more management systems requirements or Non-compliance to statutory rules, regulations and legal requirements.

Conditions which may lead to Major NC include:

i. Failure to document and implement MSC requirements effectively;

ii. Failure with direct impact on the quality of services/ product/Serious environmental concerns/ safety issues leading to serious injury/fatality, etc. (related to the relevant management system);

iii. Multiple minor failures that cumulatively indicate that capability of management system to achieve the expected outcome is in doubt;

iv. Unresolved minor NCs within the agreed framework of time;

v. Violation of statutory and regulatory requirements and no action taken to remedy the situation and

vi. The total breakdown of system/control/procedures

(b) <u>Minor NC:</u> Isolated lapse(s) within a particular process/ activity or an inadequate implementation/ breakdown of a process/ activity which can be readily rectified and which do not impact the capability to achieve the expected outcome.

4.0.Opportunity For Improvements (OFIs) :

Allows an auditor to share valuable ideas for improvement of management system. In fact, a well thought out OFI, in many cases may be of more value than a well written Non-Conformity. However, non-implementation of OFI may not lead to Non-Conformity, as it is not supported by ISO 19011, ISO-17021, etc. However, in future this could pose a situation where NCs could be considered.

5.0. Time Frame to close NCs:

(a) For Minor NCs, corrective actions to be completed preferably within 45 days but before next audit cycle.

(b) For Major NCs, the auditee must provide objective evidence of a root cause analysis and proposed corrective action plan. This should be provided within 14 days of audit and the NC to be closed within a further period of 14 days. However, identification/ issuance of Major NC will lead to withholding Certification/ Re-Certification decision.

Non-Conformities:

a) Be a statement of NC written in a clear concise manner; Be self-explanatory and related to the issue, not just be a re-statement of audit evidence or be used in-lieu of audit evidence.

b) Be supported by objective evidence, justifying the extent of evidence (e.g. record numbers, etc.,) stating what exactly was found or not found, identifying the location or basis for the evidence (eg. in records, procedure, interview or visual observation).

c) Specific requirements which have not been met, to be identified, using the words of specific management system requirements.

Non-Conformities can be written under more than one clause. Therefore, it is auditor's responsibility to determine the impact of NC on Management System and assign the appropriate clause.